

CLEVER GIRL INVESTOR: MEET REGINA BYRD

Meet Regina Byrd. She is a generational wealth specialist. She is also the founder and CEO of Prosper with Regina LLC (prosperwithregina.com) and author of the book, *10 Prosperity Secrets for the Young and Fly*. Her mission is to educate mothers and their teenagers on how to achieve financial independence and create generational wealth. She does this by teaching them how to create multiple streams of income, how to invest to build wealth, and how to protect the wealth that they build. Her biggest reward comes from doing work that gives mothers the tools and resources they need to be successful in life.

Q. How did investing play a part in your journey to financial wellness as a young woman?

A. Investing played a part in my journey because it helped me to understand how money really works. Building wealth is more than just receiving a paycheck; it is also understanding how you can take a set amount of money and grow it. Investing opened my eyes to understanding the importance of compound interest and how I needed to allow my money to work for me so I could get to a place of financial empowerment. Investing opened my eyes to the world of how money works, and I have never looked back. When I was younger, I did not invest. Today I do. I'm 34 and I can tell you what I do now. I invest on my own and through my job. My job provides a 6% contribution match for my 401(k). So, I contribute 10% of my income and take advantage of the 6% match from my company. Every pay period, I also allocate a certain amount of my money for investments. I either invest in marketing for my business or knowledge that will yield a return from me applying what I learned in my business. I may also purchase a stock or fund for myself to add to my portfolio. Usually I invest mostly in stocks or funds, but lately I have been heavily researching REITs (Real Estate Investment Trusts) and have started investing there. Also last year, I purchased my very first home in cash at the age of 33. Even though we currently live in the home, it was purchased as an investment property. We are in the process of fixing it up to rent out soon.